

YOUR KITCHEN, YOUR CALL

A Hambo's guide

What to organise, when to organise it, and how to talk to tradies so they actually turn up.

For	You. Keep it on the fridge.
Starts	The day you pay your deposit
Ends	The day your splashback goes on
Questions	Jess — 0411 330 905

← Read the countdown first.
It's the whole job on one page.

WHY YOU'VE GOT THIS

A kitchen is four or five trades turning up in the right order. We've done it hundreds of times, so rather than charge you to project-manage it, we've written down exactly how it goes. Follow it and your kitchen goes in clean.

Nothing here is complicated. It's mostly about ringing people early and then leaving them alone.

BOOK YOUR TRADES EARLY. EVERYTHING ELSE IS EASY.

HOW THIS WORKS.

We design it. We quote it. We supply it. That is the whole business, and we say it that way on purpose. We don't install, we don't build and we don't project-manage — so the trades that fit your kitchen off are booked by you, and paid by you, direct.

That sounds like extra work. It's actually the reason you're getting this kitchen for what you're paying.

WHAT WE DO.

- ☐ Measure up and design the kitchen
- ☐ Draw the plans and get them right before anything is ordered
- ☐ Quote the cabinetry and the benchtop as one price
- ☐ Order it, track it, and check every box off when it lands
- ☐ Deliver it to your place
- ☐ Arrange our preferred installer if you'd rather not do it yourself
- ☐ Book the stone templater once your cabinets are in
- ☐ Answer the phone when you're not sure

WHAT YOU DO.

- ☐ Fit the kitchen yourself, or have us arrange our installer
- ☐ Book your plumber and electrician
- ☐ Book your splashback trade and, if you're having bulkheads, your plasterer and painter
- ☐ Agree the price with each of them up front
- ☐ Pay them direct
- ☐ Be there, or have someone there, on install day

That's it. Five phone calls, spread over two months.

The honest version. A cabinetmaker who does the lot marks up every trade that walks through your door, and you pay for their office while you're at it. Cutting that out is why a Hambo's kitchen comes in **at least 30% under** a cabinetmaker quote for the same job — same manufacturer, same hardware, same finish. You're not getting less kitchen. You're making a handful of phone calls we'd otherwise charge you for.

FITTING IT YOURSELF?

Plenty of our customers do, and there's no reason you can't. Your cabinetry comes flat packed — the same as the big flat-pack retailers — and like them it doesn't come with a step-by-step booklet. **Your cabinetry plan is the instructions.** Every box is labelled with a cabinetry number that matches a cabinet on that plan.

BEFORE YOU START.

- ☐ Have the plan printed and in front of you, not on a phone
- ☐ **Open every single box first.** Fillers and end panels are often packed away from the cabinet they belong to — they're frequently not in the same box
- ☐ Check each cabinet off against the plan before you put it anywhere
- ☐ Find the accessory box — adjustable legs, screws and hardware live in there
- ☐ Work out your kick height before the first cabinet goes down

FILLERS VS END PANELS.

These are not interchangeable, and your plan is marked to show which goes where.

- **Fillers** go against walls and into corners, and anywhere a bit of adjustment or clearance is needed.
- **End panels** go on exposed ends — anywhere the finished end of a cabinet stays visible.

Check the plan. Don't assume a panel is a panel.

Get halfway and change your mind? That's fine. Ring Jess on 0411 330 905 and we'll arrange our preferred installer to pick it up from wherever you've got to. Nobody will give you a hard time about it.

► ONE THING WE CAN'T DO IS FIT IT FOR YOU — HAMBO'S SUPPLIES, AND THAT'S DELIBERATE. IT'S WHAT KEEPS THE PRICE WHERE IT IS.

THE COUNTDOWN.

From the day you pay your deposit to the day your splashback goes on. Roughly eight to ten weeks, start to finish.

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT YOU DO
Order confirmed	You've paid your 50% deposit and signed the final plan. Your kitchen goes into production.	Ring your trades now. Tell them the kitchen is 7 to 8 weeks away and ask them to pencil the job in. Don't wait for a date — get on their radar.
Weeks 1-6	Your kitchen is being made. We get a production update every week.	Nothing. Go and choose your tapware and your handles if you haven't.
We call you	We confirm your kitchen is on the truck and give you a delivery date.	Book your trades in properly now. Firm dates, not "sometime that week". Start with your installer — everyone else works around him.

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT YOU DO
Week 7-8	Kitchen lands in our shed. We check every box against your plan. Balance is due.	Pay the balance so we can deliver. Text your trades to confirm the dates you booked.
Delivery day	We drop the kitchen at your place.	Clear somewhere dry for it. Don't open anything or move it around.
Install day	Old kitchen out, new kitchen in — same day. Your installer fits the cabinets.	Your plumber has to be there. Sparky too if the cooktop or oven is moving.
Cabinets in	We book the stone templater. Don't arrange stone yourself — it can't be measured until the cabinetry is in and levelled.	Ring Jess on 0411 330 905 the moment the cabinets are in and level. That call is what starts the stone.
About 10 days later	Templater attends, then the stone benchtop goes in.	Be there to let them in, keep the benches clear, and get your plumber back to reconnect the sink.
After the stone	Splashback goes on. Plasterer and painter finish any bulkheads.	Have these two booked before the stone goes in, not after.

► SUGGESTED — HAMBO'S TO CONFIRM THE SPLASHBACK AND PLASTER ORDER FOR YOUR PARTICULAR JOB BEFORE THIS GOES OUT.

YOUR KEY DATES.

Fill these in as they get locked in. If someone rings you asking when something is happening, the answer is on this page.

Deposit paid

Trades pencilled in

Kitchen confirmed by Hambo's

Balance paid

Delivery day

Install day

Stone template

Stone in

YOUR TRADES.

Five people, and you probably won't need all five. Fill this in as you book them, and keep it with the plan.

TRADE	WHAT THEY DO	NAME	NUMBER	BOOKED
Cabinet installer	Fits the kitchen. Book first — everyone works around this day. Doing it yourself? Put your own name here. Otherwise ring Jess and we'll arrange ours.	Hambo's	0411 330 905	
Plumber	Disconnects the old sink, reconnects the new one. On site install day.			
Electrician	Cooktop, oven, rangehood, and any LED strip under the cabinets.			
Splashback	Tiler or glazier. Goes on after the stone.			
Stone benchtop	We book this one. Ring us when the cabinets are in and levelled.	Hambo's	0411 330 905	
Plasterer / painter	Only if you're having bulkheads built above the cabinets.			

Haven't got a plumber or a sparky? Ask us. We work alongside these trades every week and we'll put you onto someone who'll turn up and do a proper job. We don't take a cut and we don't add anything to their price — it's just a name and a number. And if you'd rather not fit the kitchen yourself, our preferred installer is always happy to help — ring Jess on **0411 330 905** and we'll arrange it.

← *Write their mobile down. You'll want it on the day.*

HOW TO TALK TO A TRADIE.

This isn't a joke section. Getting five trades to turn up on the right day is the whole game, and most of it comes down to how you contact them.

DO THIS.

- **Text, don't ring.** A tradie on the tools can't answer the phone but he can read a text at smoko. You'll get an answer faster.

DON'T DO THIS.

- Ring three times in a day. He'll stop picking up.

- **Book early, confirm late.** Pencil it in the day your order is confirmed. Lock the date in when we tell you the kitchen's here.
- **Text two days before.** "Morning mate, still right for Wednesday? Kitchen's going in." That one text is the difference between him turning up and him double-booking you.
- **Agree the price before the day.** Ask what it'll cost and whether he invoices or takes cash. Get it in a text so you both have it.
- **Have the money ready.** A lot of trades prefer cash and will sharpen their price for it. Sort that out beforehand, not while he's packing up.

- Book him for "sometime next week". Give him a date.
- Assume he remembers. He's got eight jobs on.
- Leave the price until he's finished.
- Ask him to change something on the kitchen. That comes to us.
- Early
- By text
- Confirmed twice
- Price agreed

Four things. That's the whole trick.

ON THE DAY.

HAVE READY.

- ☐ Your plan, printed, where the installer can see it
- ☐ **Every box opened** before a cabinet goes in — fillers and end panels are often packed away from the cabinet they belong to
- ☐ The kitchen cleared right out — benches, cupboards, floor
- ☐ Somewhere to park a ute or two
- ☐ Power on and water on
- ☐ Your plumber's mobile in your pocket
- ☐ A kettle somewhere else in the house

EXPECT.

- A long day. Old kitchen out and new one in is a big day's work.
- Some cabinets built on site — that's normal, not a problem
- Noise, dust and a saw set up outside
- No benchtop for about ten days after. Plan your meals.
- No sink for a day or two. That's the bit people forget.

The one rule that matters. Nothing gets cut, trimmed or drilled that came out of our boxes. Every panel and filler is made to the plan. If something won't fit, it's almost certainly not meant to go there – stop and ring us. We warrant anything damaged in manufacture or transport. We can't warrant a part that's been modified on site, and a replacement takes seven to eight weeks to be remade.

ANYTHING ELSE?

RING US IF...

- Something's damaged or missing when the boxes are opened. Same day, with a photo.
- A part won't go where the plan says.
- You want to change something – before it's ordered if you can.
- You're just not sure. That's what we're here for.

WHO TO RING.

Hambo's — Jess

0411 330 905

Email admin@hambos.com.au

Your order number

One number covers the lot – the plan, the installer, the stone, and anything that doesn't look right. Showroom is Tue–Thu 9–4, Fri 8–12, and the first Saturday of the month.

This guide covers the *organising*. The **Cabinetry Installation Guide** that came with your kitchen covers the *fitting*. Keep both.

TWO TEXTS TO SEND.

Copy these. Between them they do most of the organising for you – one at the start so you're on the books, one two days out so nobody forgets.

NOTES – DATES, NAMES, ANYTHING.

Your installer

Your plumber

Your electrician

WHEN WE CONFIRM YOUR ORDER.

"Hi mate, it's [your name] — getting a new kitchen in from Hambo's, should land in about 7 to 8 weeks. Any chance you could pencil me in? I'll confirm the exact date as soon as I've got it."

TWO DAYS BEFORE THE INSTALL.

"Morning mate, still right for [day]? Kitchen's going in. Sing out if anything's changed."

Send the second one even if you already confirmed last week. It takes ten seconds and it is the single thing most likely to stop your day falling over.

KIT YOU'LL WANT, IF YOU'RE FITTING IT YOURSELF.

► OUR SUGGESTION, NOT A SUPPLIED LIST — ADD WHAT YOU KNOW YOU'LL NEED

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Cordless drill and a set of driver bits | ☐ Packers or shims for a floor that isn't flat |
| ☐ A 1200 mm spirit level — a short one will let you down across a long run | ☐ A trolley, and a second pair of hands — drawer units are genuinely heavy |
| ☐ Two or three clamps for holding cabinets together while you fix them | ☐ A clear room to lay every box out before you start |
| ☐ Tape, pencil, square | ☐ Your plan, printed |
- ---

You'll notice there's no saw on that list. That's on purpose. If something needs trimming, ring us before you cut it — see the rule a couple of pages back.

YOUR NAME

YOUR ORDER NUMBER

DELIVERY DATE



Kitchens · Bathrooms · Laundries · Wardrobes
Unit 2, 15 Freighter Ave, Wilsonton QLD 4350 · 0411 330 905 ·
admin@hambos.com.au

BUILT WITH

GoAsk.

Supply only ·
hamboshomemakercentre.com.au